

What it takes to win

A briefing for teammates who already know how to build. Judging this year is feasibility and Business Units. The kill shot is claiming we replace Passenger Recovery. The wedge is the last 90 minutes at HKG T1.

Start here

JUDGES	Feasibility, Business Units, path to adoption.
DATES	Apply 2026-09-27. 24h 2026-11-14/15. Pitch 2026-11-15. Demo 2026-11-16.
SHAPE	Transfer-desk control loop. Not a lifestyle app.
KILL SHOT	Claiming we replace Amadeus Passenger Recovery.
WEDGE	Last 90 minutes at HKG T1: UM, wheelchair, unsplittable party, MCT + walk, agent-visible reasoning.

FlyLab (employee, existing packs, humans decide) is the analogue. U-Explore is not. Pitch **beside** Passenger Recovery.

Beside, not instead — CX already bought the left box

Mass IROPS (bought)
Passenger Recovery · 8,000 pax / 40 min
Accenture self-rebook · 15below notify
Amadeus Self Re-accommodation

does not replace

HKG T1 desk (this repo)
last 90 min · agent confirm
MCT + walk + UM + WCH + party
reasoning[] · CANS after approve

Rogers 2019 named the airborne-misconnect gap. Week-1 Altéa is read-only. HX is Navitaire — different PSS, different sentence.

Unknowns

- 2018 overall champion name was not found in Cathay press. Anita and Lugless are sourced as runners-up only.
- 2021 overall champion name was not found in Cathay press. GME is a public participant repo, not the trophy. Dean Fung is sourced as second runner-up only.
- 2020: no primary press found. Numbering is 3rd annual (2018) then 4th (2021).

Saturday — 90 seconds

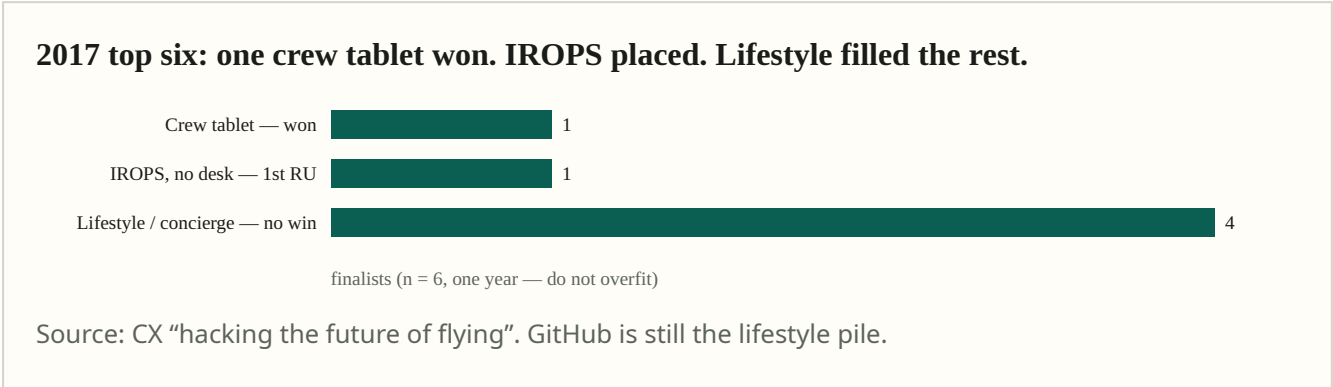
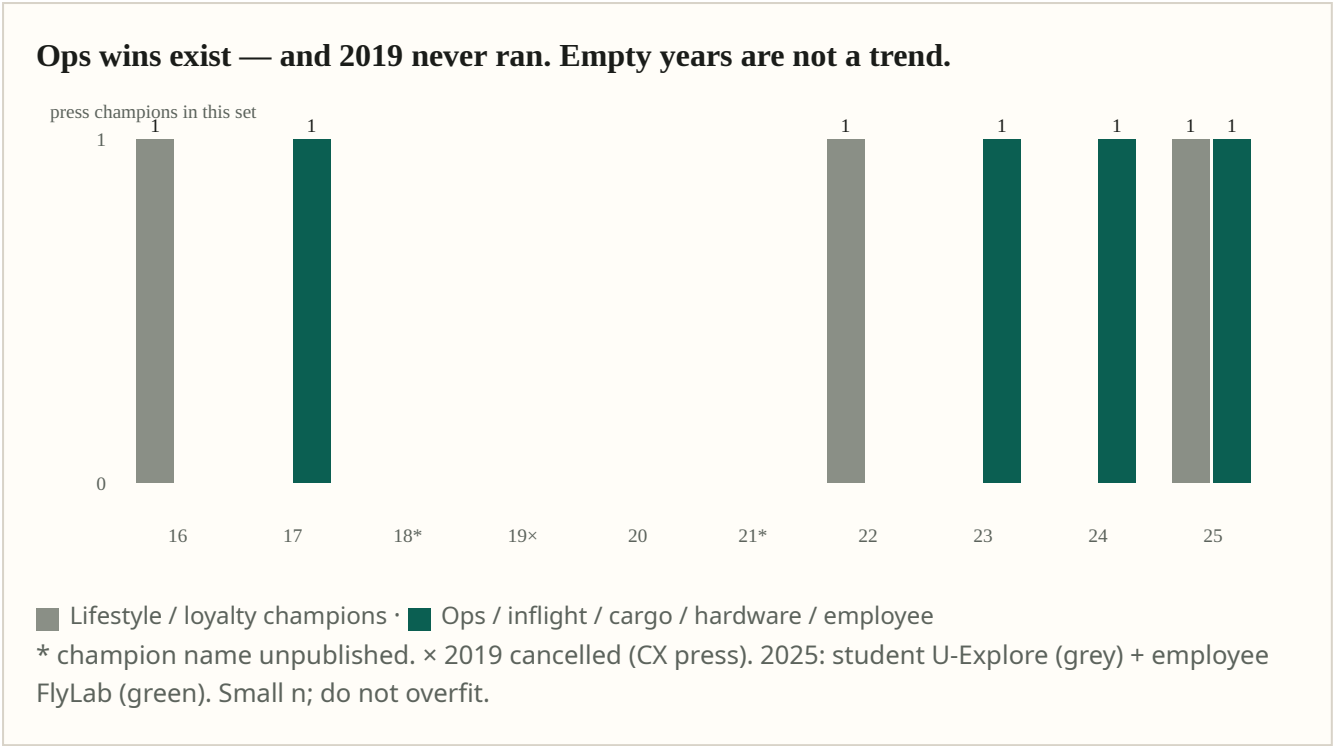
Same six steps as docs/DEMO .md. Say this, then stop.

Clock	Demo	Say	Show
0–15s	1–2	HKG transfer desk. Q77. Not a trip planner.	Station clock + live queue
15–35s	3	Typhoon. The bank moves. Queue refreshes. No reload.	Simulate Typhoon Delay
35–50s	4	CX254 +180. Rogers wanted this airborne in 2019. We do it on the iPad.	Late Inbound CX254
50–70s	5	Engine ranked this. reasoning[] is verbatim. The model did not pick the flight.	Option card + reasoning
70–90s	6	Draft is guarded. Approve is the only send. Beside Passenger Recovery, not instead.	Approve Rebooking & Send

If a judge talks, do not improvise

Do not say	Say instead
AI for aviation / ChatGPT rebooking	HKG transfer desk. Q77. Altéa is cryptic. The iPad is the glass.
We replace Passenger Recovery	Beside it. Last 90 minutes. UM, WCH, unsplittable party.
The model picked the flight	Engine ranked it. reasoning[] is verbatim. LLM drafted the SMS.
We'll add a robot / trolley next	FlyLab won without one. GingTrip came back a year later. We already have the button.

What the record actually shows



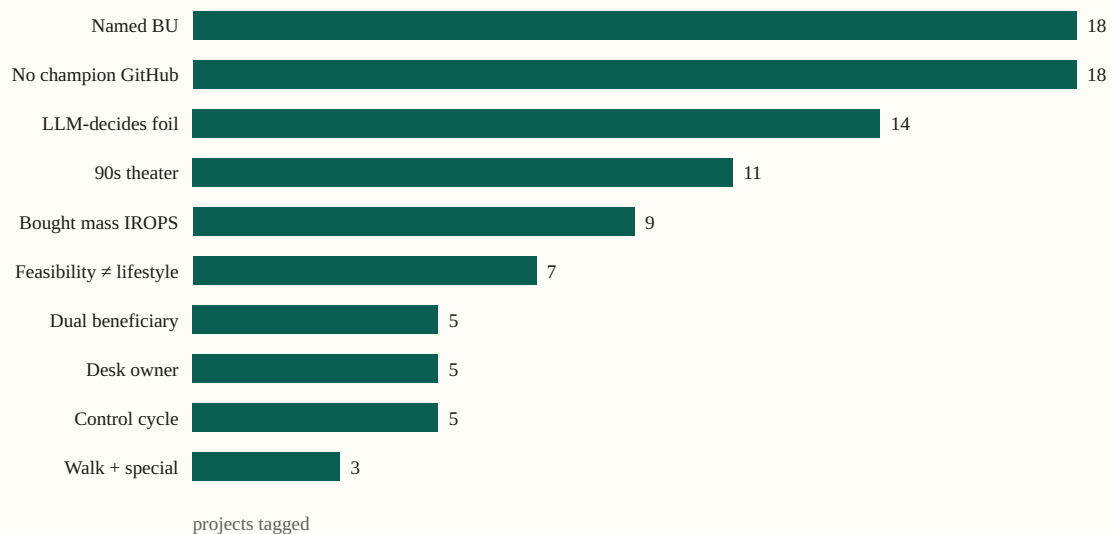
Press champions in this set still have no public repo. One 2023 runner-up does.



■ Public GitHub in this set

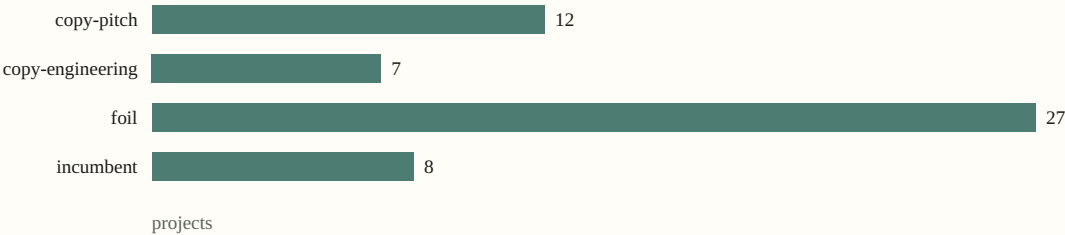
FlyMate (2nd RU) is the podium GitHub. GME 2021 is a participant, not a trophy. Stars are not the scoreboard.

How often each pattern shows up in this corpus (n = this database, not all aviation).



A tag is a claim, not a vote. High count on llm-foil means the GitHub default is still ChatGPT.

Most of what GitHub shows you is a foil. Incumbents are few and already bought.



copy-pitch = steal the sentence. copy-engineering = steal the shape. foil = do not demo like this. incumbent = sit beside.

The room got bigger, then it split tracks

Year	Teams	Applications	What that year did
2017	28 teams	—	Inflight NFC (TouchCX) won. IROPS placed, no desk.
2022	20 teams	500 apps	Cathay Green: first pitch ran out of time; finals presentation won.
2023	64 teams	1,500 apps	Cargo CV (NAAR) won. FlyMate (PRM app) 2nd RU. GingTrip was in the room and lost.
2025	36 student + 12 employee	1,900 student + 200 employee	Two champions: U-Explore (student) and FlyLab (employee). Top 3 each track → Cathay Innovate, fund up to HK\$500k.

2022–2025 figures: Swire/CX press. 2017 teams: CX TouchCX story. 2024 apps not in press — omitted.

Ten patterns

If two conflict in a sentence, keep named-BU, feasibility-2026, incumbent-IROPS, and LLM-foil.

1 Named BU beats generic AI

WINNERS Attach to HK Express, Cargo, Inflight, or Flight Ops in the first sentence.

WE HAVE HKG transfer desk / Airport Systems is the owner. Say that, not “AI for aviation”.

SATURDAY Open with the desk, the queue, and Q77 — not the model.

2 90-second theater

WINNERS Judges must see the product: trolley, robot, briefing card, typhoon button.

WE HAVE Simulate Typhoon Delay and Late Inbound CX254 already refresh the live queue.

SATURDAY Narrate the six-step demo as ops, not as a tech tour.

3 Dual beneficiary

WINNERS Passenger care plus a second ledger: revenue, labour, ESG data, or safety.

WE HAVE Passenger protection plus desk throughput in a typhoon bank.

SATURDAY Name both: misconnect care and minutes off the transfer queue.

4 Feasibility 2026 is not lifestyle 2025

WINNERS BU judges now score adoption path. FlyLab (pilots + IT, summarise existing briefings) is the closer analogue than U-Explore.

WE HAVE Deterministic engine, Altéa/FIDS/CANS pilot note, no Altéa write in week 1.

SATURDAY We sit beside Passenger Recovery. We do not replace it.

5 Champions rarely open-source

WINNERS Win on pain, BU, and theater. Public GitHub is mostly participant trip planners.

WE HAVE A real repo with tests. Do not treat GitHub stars as the scoreboard.

SATURDAY Show the iPad and the reasoning strings, not a star count.

6 Delay re-plan without a desk owner loses

WINNERS Fight4Flight (2017 runner-up) notified and re-planned from the passenger side. It did not win.

WE HAVE Agent-in-the-loop on an iPad. Approve is the only send.

SATURDAY The missing 2017 piece was the transfer desk. That is the product.

7 Cathay already bought mass IROPS

WINNERS Do not pitch into a purchased capability as if the market were empty.

WE HAVE Last-90-minute special handling: UM, wheelchair, unsplittable party, MCT + walk.

SATURDAY Passenger Recovery does 8,000 pax / 40 min. We do tight connections the mass tool cannot walk-time.

8 LLM-decides-rebooking is a foil

WINNERS BU and IT will not let a model pick the flight.

WE HAVE Engine decides. LLM drafts. Flight-number guard. reasoning[] is verbatim.

SATURDAY The guard is the product, not ChatGPT.

9 Control cycle, station clock, sim, kill switch

WINNERS SpaceX-class ops: read inputs, compute state, write outputs, wait for the clock. Config for non-software engineers.

WE HAVE FIDS + PNR in, slack/MCT state, options + draft out. MCT table is the DSL. Sim seed.

RECONNECT_PILOT=off.

SATURDAY Say it in ops English, not brand English.

10 Walk time and special handling are the wedge

WINNERS ConnectionSaver treated gate walk as a product (SMS with minutes). MCT tables lie for PRM and UM.

WE HAVE Gate walk +15 WCH +20 UM, CX-metal-only for UM, unsplittable party, downgrade protection.

SATURDAY Mass reaccom does not escort an unaccompanied minor through HKG T1.

What lost, and what we had wrong

Year	Case	Result	Why it is a warning
2017	Fight4Flight	1st runner-up	Delay re-plan from the passenger side. No transfer-desk owner. Closest ancestor; it lost.
2017	Aviator	2nd runner-up	Saw connections as a dining/activity moment. Recovery is the job.
2017	Hacksmart	top six	Chat itinerary planner. The 2023 GitHub corpus is this idea with Azure.
2023	FlyMate	2nd runner-up	Named PRM. Built a passenger GenAI app. Cargo CV won. WCH is already +15 min in mct.ts.
2024	SMASH	participant	Same HK Express waste pain as GingTrip. Dashboard, no trolley. Theater lost.
2025	U-Explore	student champion	Won 2025 lifestyle. 2026 scoring is feasibility + BU. FlyLab is the analogue, not this.
2025	FlyVision	participant	AWS Rekognition a year after NAAR won cargo CV. Copying last year's technique is not a desk.

Corrections to this pack

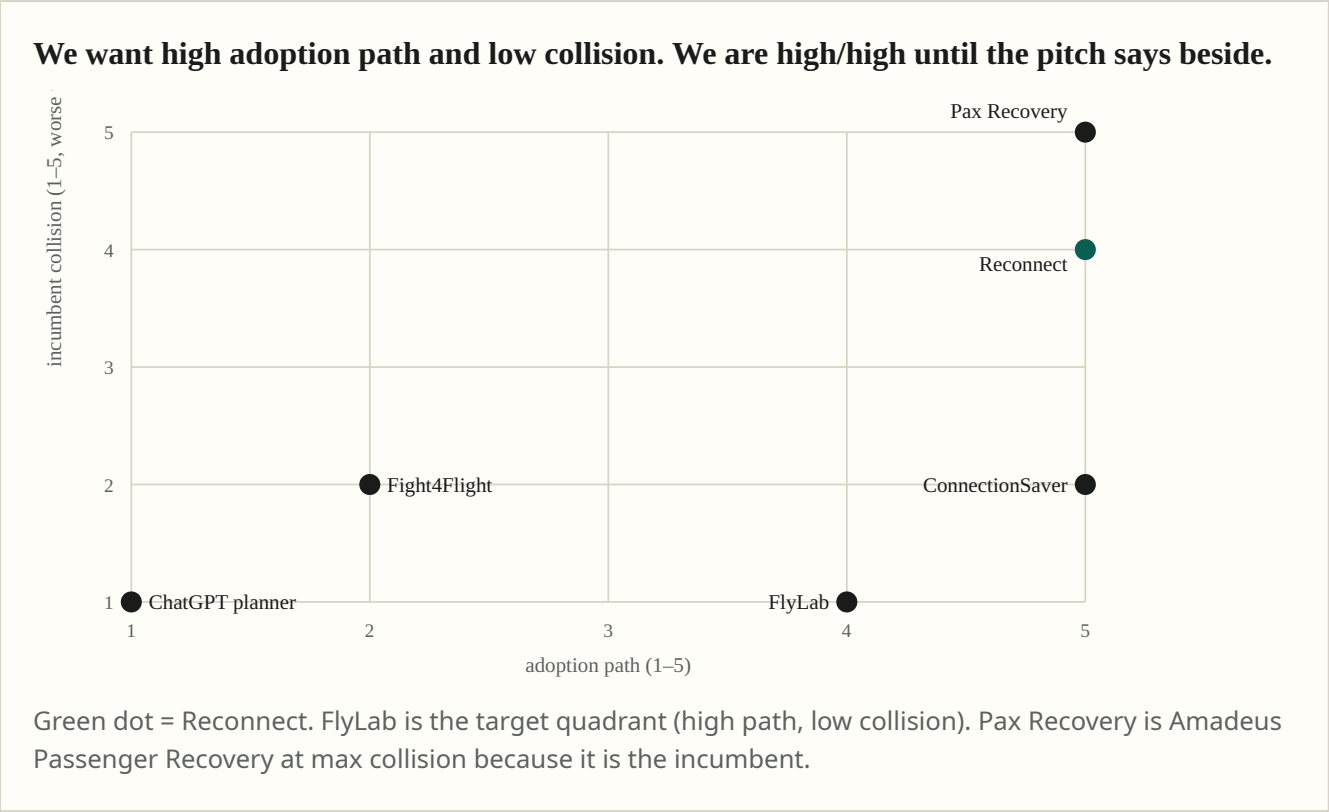
- GME 2021 is a public participant repo, not a press-named champion. The 2021 champion name is unpublished, same as 2018.
- 2019 event was cancelled (Cathay press, 8 Nov 2019). Do not read the empty year as 'ops had not been invented yet'.
- 2020: no primary press found. Numbering goes 3rd (2018) → 4th (2021). Do not invent a 2020 champion.
- 2022 CX press: first physical full event at Cathay City since 2018. 2021 podium existed (Dean Fung); format is unpublished.
- FlyMate / Skydreamers is the 2023 2nd runner-up with a public repo. NAAR won. A podium GitHub is still not a champion GitHub.

Cathay record 2016–2025

Year	Result	Name	BU	GitHub	Takeaway
2016	champion	cxDiscovery	Inflight / Lifestyle	no	State a second beneficiary (desk throughput), not only passenger care.
2017	runner-up	Aviator	Airport / connections	no	Connecting passengers are the moment; recovery is the job.
2017	finalist	Betsy	Lifestyle	no	A countdown is useful. Ours is slack-to-MCT on the agent iPad, not a concierge clock.
2017	finalist	Cathay First	Inflight / Lifestyle	no	Personalisation lost to a crew workflow. Do not demo a content recommender.
2017	runner-up	Fight4Flight	Customer experience	no	Passenger-only re-plan loses. The desk is the missing 2017 piece.
2017	finalist	Hacksmart	Lifestyle	no	The 2023 GitHub corpus is Hacksmart with Azure. Judges have seen it for a decade.
2017	champion	TouchCX	Inflight	no	Win by sitting on a crew/agent device, not another passenger super-app.
2018	runner-up	Anita chatbot	Digital / CX	no	Notify is not recover. We notify after an agent approves a protected flight.
2018	runner-up	Lugless	Baggage / CX	no	Bags are out of SCOPE. Do not add them before Saturday.
2019	cancelled	2019 Hackathon (cancelled)	—	no	Do not read 2023–2025 ops wins as a new law of nature. 2019 never ran. 2021 champion is unpublished.
2021	runner-up	Dean Fung (2021 2nd RU)	unpublished	no	Do not fill the 2021 champion cell with GME because GME has GitHub.
2021	participant	GME / Asia Miles visualiser	Loyalty	yes	A cloneable repo is not a trophy. 2021 champion name is unpublished, same failure mode as 2018.
2022	champion	Cathay Green	Sustainability / Lifestyle	no	Ryan Lam: first pitch ran out of time; finals presentation won. Narrate the buttons. Only claim ESG if we can count stranded nights.
2023	runner-up	FlyMate (Skydreamers)	Accessibility	yes	A podium PRM app is not a desk. WCH +15 is already in mct.ts. Say the number; do not demo their chatbot.
2023	participant	GingTrip (2023 attempt)	HK Express / Inflight	no	They needed a year and a trolley. We already have the typhoon button. Do not wait.
2023	champion	NAAR cargo dimensioning	Cargo	no	Lead with a number (minutes, pax, queue length). NAAR led with accuracy and labour.
2024	champion	GingTrip modular trolley	HK Express / Inflight	no	They lost in 2023, came back with a trolley (Andy Ng, CX 2024). We already have the typhoon button. Do not wait a year, and do not add a robot.
2025	champion	FlyLab pre-flight briefings	Flight Ops	no	Closest 2025 analogue. Pair with a transfer agent. Do not invent a new PSS.
2025	runner-up	Niki Jr.	Customer experience /	no	Presentation award is theater. We already have buttons; narrate them.

Year	Result	Name	BU	GitHub	Takeaway
heritage					
2025	champion	U-Explore (Kairos Takeoff Crew)	HK Express	no	Do not copy the loyalty app. Copy the named BU and the lived pain sentence.

Reconnect scorecard



Engine: `mct.ts CX_CX 50, walk 10, WCH +15, UM +20. score.ts tier×3 + seat×2 – delay/10. guard.ts.`
Pilot note.

	BU	Theater	Path	Collision	Cite
Reconnect	5	3	5	4	mct.ts CX_CX 50 + walk 10; WCH +15; UM +20; score.ts; guard.ts; PILOT_PROPOSAL.md
FlyLab 2025	5	3	4	1	Employee track: pilots + IT, summarise existing briefings.
Fight4Flight 2017	2	3	2	2	Passenger re-plan, no desk. Runner-up.
Passenger Recovery	5	2	5	5	8,000 pax / 40 min. CX production ~2018.
ConnectionSaver	5	4	5	2	Walk-time SMS. Hold, not rebook.
ChatGPT trip planner	1	2	1	1	angusf777 CathayConnect. Foil.

1–5. Collision is worse when high. Scatter: X = adoption path, Y = collision. We want high/low.

How we win — grouped

PITCH

L01 Open with Airport Systems / HKG transfer desk, not “AI for aviation”.

L02 Name two beneficiaries: the passenger and the typhoon queue.

L05 Use coach language: Q77 + Altéa cryptic is the bottleneck.

L06 Claim ESG only if we can count fewer stranded nights. Otherwise omit.

L07 Agent-in-the-loop is why Fight4Flight lost and we should not.

L08 Pair the pitch with a real CX role (transfer agent + IT), FlyLab-style.

L12 Call the engine a control cycle on station time. MCT table is the DSL.

L13 Seeded sim = HOOTL. Live adapter = HITL. RECONNECT_PILOT=off is abort.

L15 Walk + WCH + UM is the wedge. ConnectionSaver made walk-time a product.

L19 Use ChatGPT trip planners and GPT compensation as foils, not as features.

L20 Do not invent impact numbers. NAAR and ConnectionSaver led with real ones; we do not have them yet.

L21 2019 was cancelled. Do not treat the empty year as proof that ops products only started winning in 2023.

L22 GME is a cloneable 2021 repo, not a press champion. Do not fill unpublished trophy cells from GitHub.

L24 2017 top six: one crew tablet won; one IROPS app placed; four lifestyle tools did not. The mix has not changed.

DEMO

L03 Narrate demo steps 3–6 as ops theater (typhoon, CX254, reasoning, approve).

L09 Say: LLM drafts; engine decides; guard strips hallucinated flights.

L14 Describe the iPad as one glass (queue, connection, action). Open MCT analogue.

L28 Cathay Green ran out of time on the first pitch and still won the finals. Narrate steps 3–6; do not add a robot.

L25 GingTrip lost in 2023 and came back with a trolley. We already have the typhoon button. Do not wait a year.

L26 2025 split student vs employee tracks (36 + 12 teams). FlyLab is the employee-track analogue. Pair with a CX role.

L27 Do not copy last year's winning technique. FlyVision rebuilt cargo CV after NAAR already won it.

L29 2023 2nd RU FlyMate is a GenAI PRM app with GitHub. WCH is already +15 min in mct.ts. Do not demo a passenger chatbot.

PILOT

L10 Sit beside Passenger Recovery as the last-90-minute special-handling layer.

L11 Pilot metrics already in PILOT_PROPOSAL: 5s queue, reasoning not from LLM, flight-number-safe push.

L18 Do not scrape public FIDS. Pilot uses operational MQTT. OpenSky is research-only.

L23 HX is Navitaire New Skies. CX transfer is Altéa. One PSS sentence does not cover both BUs.

LATER

L04 Do not add hardware or a robot. FlyLab won without one.

L16 Hold-the-outbound is a different decision. Park it in LATER. Know it exists.

L17 Do not import MILP aircraft-crew recovery. That is AOCC, not T1.

Project explorer

cxDiscovery

2016 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-pitch · high

Personalised inflight e-magazine plus vendor targeting.

Strength. Named inflight publications as the pain

Weakness. Not an ops tool

Takeaway. State a second beneficiary (desk throughput), not only passenger care.

No public repo

[Cathay inaugural hackathon 2016](#)

TouchCX

2017 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-pitch · high

Passenger phone to crew tablet for amenity requests (NFC).

Strength. Crew workflow, not a concierge chatbot

Weakness. Cabin not transfer desk

Takeaway. Win by sitting on a crew/agent device, not another passenger super-app.

No public repo

[Inflight services app wins 2017](#)

Fight4Flight

2017 · cathay-winner · runner-up · copy-pitch · high

Delay notification and re-planning from the passenger side.

Strength. Closest ancestor of Reconnect

Weakness. No transfer-desk owner

Takeaway. Passenger-only re-plan loses. The desk is the missing 2017 piece.

No public repo

[2017 top six ideas](#)

Aviator

2017 · cathay-winner · runner-up · foil · high

Dining and activity manager aimed at connecting passengers.

Strength. Saw connections as a moment

Weakness. Lifestyle layer on top of misconnect, not recovery

Takeaway. Connecting passengers are the moment; recovery is the job.

No public repo

[2017 top six ideas](#)

GME / Asia Miles visualiser

2021 · cathay-winner · participant · foil · high

Map and proximity for Asia Miles partners, plus redemption notices. Public 2021 repo — not a press-named champion.

Strength. Named loyalty BU

Weakness. Lifestyle, not ops

Takeaway. A cloneable repo is not a trophy. 2021 champion name is unpublished, same failure mode as 2018.

[GitHub](#)

[markmcwong/cathay-hackathon-2021](#)

Cathay Green

2022 · cathay-winner · champion · foil · high

Currency and AI to promote carbon offset and green practice.

Strength. ESG as a named Cathay theme that year

Weakness. Easy to fake ESG in 2026 feasibility judging

Takeaway. Ryan Lam: first pitch ran out of time; finals presentation won. Narrate the buttons. Only claim ESG if we can count stranded nights.

No public repo

[5th Annual Cathay Hackathon](#)

NAAR cargo dimensioning

2023 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-pitch · high

Computer vision to size cargo and pack denser, with less manual labour.

Strength. Cargo \$ and labour

Weakness. Hardware/CV, not passenger recovery

Takeaway. Lead with a number (minutes, pax, queue length). NAAR led with accuracy and labour.

No public repo

[6th annual Cathay Hackathon](#)

GingTrip modular trolley

2024 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-pitch · high

Modular galley trolley that sorts cabin waste and feeds a dashboard.

Strength. Touchable theater

Weakness. Physical build is not our path

Takeaway. They lost in 2023, came back with a trolley (Andy Ng, CX 2024). We already have the typhoon button. Do not wait a year, and do not add a robot.

No public repo

[Aircraft Interiors: GingTrip 2024 · 7th annual: GingTrip returned after 2023](#)

U-Explore (Kairos Takeoff Crew)

2025 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-pitch · high

All-in-one HK Express customer-journey platform: loyalty, community, gamified content.

Strength. Lived traveller pain

Weakness. Lifestyle; weaker under 2026 feasibility scoring unless a BU owns a 30-day pilot

Takeaway. Do not copy the loyalty app. Copy the named BU and the lived pain sentence.

No public repo

Swire: 8th annual Cathay Hackathon

Niki Jr.

2025 · cathay-winner · runner-up · foil · high

Polaroid robot named after CX DC-3 Niki; app booking, crowd-aware queueing.

Strength. Physical theater

Weakness. Not an ops problem

Takeaway. Presentation award is theater. We already have buttons; narrate them.

No public repo

HKUST ISD: Niki Jr.

FlyLab pre-flight briefings

2025 · cathay-winner · champion · copy-engineering · high

AI summaries of existing pre-flight briefing packs for pilots.

Strength. Real CX roles on the team

Weakness. Flight deck, not transfer desk

Takeaway. Closest 2025 analogue. Pair with a transfer agent. Do not invent a new PSS.

No public repo

Swire: 8th annual Cathay Hackathon

Anita chatbot

2018 · cathay-winner · runner-up · foil · medium

Chatbot that reminds passengers before boarding.

Strength. Proactive notify

Weakness. 2018 overall champion name not found in primary press

Takeaway. Notify is not recover. We notify after an agent approves a protected flight.

No public repo

LinkedIn: Anita first runner-up 2018

Lugless

2018 · cathay-winner · runner-up · foil · high

Bags packed and waiting at destination.

Strength. Named a physical pain

Weakness. Logistics company, not a desk tool

Takeaway. Bags are out of SCOPE. Do not add them before Saturday.

No public repo

[LinkedIn: Lugless second runner-up](#)

2019 Hackathon (cancelled)

2019 · cathay-winner · cancelled · foil · high

24-hour event scheduled 9–10 Nov 2019
cancelled after a risk assessment (HK unrest).
~250 participants offered regional tickets.

Strength. Primary press exists

Weakness. No product to copy

Takeaway. Do not read 2023–2025 ops wins as a new law of nature. 2019 never ran. 2021 champion is unpublished.

No public repo

[Cathay Pacific Hackathon 2019 cancelled](#)

Cathay First

2017 · cathay-winner · finalist · foil · high

Inflight personaliser: Facebook + Asia Miles, movie/song lists, dining, gamification. Not on the podium.

Strength. IFE is a named inflight system

Weakness. Lifestyle layer; TouchCX (crew tablet) beat this class

Takeaway. Personalisation lost to a crew workflow. Do not demo a content recommender.

No public repo

[Hacking the future of flying — top six](#)

Betsy

2017 · cathay-winner · finalist · foil · high

Travel concierge: boarding countdown, bill-split, personalised IFE. Not on the podium.

Strength. Boarding countdown is theater

Weakness. Passenger super-app

Takeaway. A countdown is useful. Ours is slack-to-MCT on the agent iPad, not a concierge clock.

No public repo

[Hacking the future of flying — top six](#)

Hacksmart

2017 · cathay-winner · finalist · foil · high

Itinerary planner with a conversational chatbot, route suggestions, Asia Miles offers. Not on the podium.

Strength. Shows the trip-planner foil is as old as 2017

Weakness. LLM-era teams keep rebuilding this

Takeaway. The 2023 GitHub corpus is Hacksmart with Azure. Judges have seen it for a decade.

No public repo

[Hacking the future of flying — top six](#)

Dean Fung (2021 2nd RU)

2021 · cathay-winner · runner-up · foil · medium

Second runner-up, 60+ teams. LinkedIn names the team, not the product. 2021 champion still unpublished in press.

Strength. Proves a 2021 podium existed

Weakness. No artifact, no BU, no repo

Takeaway. Do not fill the 2021 champion cell with GME because GME has GitHub.

No public repo

[Andrew Fung: Dean Fung 2nd RU 2021](#)

GingTrip (2023 attempt)

2023 · cathay-winner · participant · copy-pitch · high

Andy Ng, 2024 press: they took part in 2023, learned from coaches, came back and won with the trolley.

Strength. Primary quote that winners iterate across years

Weakness. 2023 artifact unpublished

Takeaway. They needed a year and a trolley. We already have the typhoon button. Do not wait.

No public repo

[7th annual Cathay Hackathon \(GingTrip quote\)](#)

Cathay-Cargo box sequencing

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Python to sequence boxes; CV sizing; zip of UI. NAAR-adjacent, not the champion repo.

Strength. Cargo packing is a real labour problem

Weakness. 24h prototype, 1 star

Takeaway. Participant GitHub is not how NAAR won. Do not chase stars.

[GitHub](#)

[gd-Sahat/Cathay-Cargo](#)

CathayConnect

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Azure OpenAI trip planner. README includes the full pitch script.

Strength. Pitch script is a useful foil

Weakness. Generic super-app

Takeaway. Steal the habit of a written pitch. Do not steal the ChatGPT planner.

[GitHub](#)

[angusf777/Cathay-Hackathon-2023](#)

ReservaCathay

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

ML overbooking plus GPT-personalised compensation offers.

Strength. Named overbooking as an airline problem

Weakness. LLM decides compensation — opposite of our invariant

Takeaway. Use this as the foil when a judge asks why we did not put GPT on ranking.

[GitHub](#)

[rrickyp/ReservaCathay](#)

FlyMate (Skydreamers)

2023 · cathay-winner · runner-up · copy-pitch · high

2023 2nd RU + Best Innovation. Flutter GenAI app for travellers with disabilities. Public repo; NAAR still won.

Strength. Named PRM as a real constraint

Weakness. Passenger chatbot, not a transfer desk

Takeaway. A podium PRM app is not a desk. WCH +15 is already in mct.ts. Say the number; do not demo their chatbot.

[GitHub](#)

[NickMC05/CathayHackathon2023-Group44](#) · Nick Kurniawan: 2023 2nd RU, FlyMate · Enoch W.: Skydreamers 2nd RU

Syd (ctrl+shift+elite)

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

React + OpenAI + DialogFlow travel buddy chatbot.

Strength. Typical 2023 student stack

Weakness. API keys in README, no ops invariant

Takeaway. This is what 2026 BU judges are tired of.

[GitHub](#)

[BrokenSpaghetti02/cathay-hack-T200](#)

TravelSync

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Vue app: chat, hotels, airport transfer, Splitwise.

Strength. Packaged a trip

Weakness. Super-app, not a Cathay desk

Takeaway. Do not add hotels to the Saturday demo.

[GitHub](#)

[TravelSync_Cathay](#)

PassportScanner

2018 · cathay-repo · participant · copy-pitch · high

Scan passport to auto-fill online check-in. Pain: <30% online check-in.

Strength. Started from a stated conversion number

Weakness. Stores passport images in the cloud — a 2026 non-starter

Takeaway. A number in the pitch is good. PNR in LLM prompts is already constrained in the pilot note.

[GitHub](#)

[alifarooqi/PassportScanner](#)

Carbon per passenger model

2022 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · medium

ML for carbon emissions per passenger per flight.

Strength. Matches 2022 theme

Weakness. Not a desk workflow

Takeaway. Theme-chasing without a desk owner is 2022, not 2026.

[GitHub](#)

[Cathay-Hackathon-2022](#)

Optimal flight route (2025 repo)

2025 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · medium

Public 2025 repo: most optimal flight route. Not the student champion.

Strength. Network problem is real

Weakness. Champion U-Explore has no public repo; this is the GitHub you will find instead

Takeaway. Search GitHub for 2025 and you will not find Kairos. That is the point.

[GitHub](#)

[anoushkapant/CathayHackathon2025](#)

MILES+

2024 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Make unused Asia Miles a daily currency.
Typical 2024 lifestyle repo.

Strength. Named a real ledger (Asia Miles)

Weakness. Engagement app, not a desk

Takeaway. A Cathay ledger is good. The transfer queue is the ledger we already have.

[GitHub](#)

[tonywong586/miles-plus](#)

Talker (2018 PWA chatbot)

2018 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Vue PWA ‘to demonstrate a chatbot’. Same year Anita (chatbot) was first runner-up.

Strength. Shows 2018 already defaulted to chat

Weakness. Demo of a chatbot, not a workflow

Takeaway. Chat as the product is an eight-year-old participant default.

[GitHub](#)

[denistsoi/cathay-hackathon-2018](#)

CathayDelight

2018 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · medium

2018 public repo. Empty README. Typical of the participant corpus.

Strength. Timestamps a 2018 GitHub presence

Weakness. No stated pain, no BU, no tests

Takeaway. An empty repo from the year we cannot name the champion is the corpus, not the bar.

[GitHub](#)

[CathayHackathon2018_CathayDelight](#)

EvoGreen

2025 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

GreenPoints + AI itinerary planner + eco inflight options. Public 2025 repo; not Kairos.

Strength. ESG + planner, the 2022/2025 default mashup

Weakness. Two lifestyle products glued together

Takeaway. Search 2025 GitHub and you get EvoGreen or a route optimiser, not U-Explore or FlyLab.

[GitHub](#)

[tlmok0330/Evo-UST](#)

SMASH waste dashboard

2024 · cathay-repo · participant · copy-pitch · high

Streamlit dashboard + AI to track HK Express flight waste. Same BU as GingTrip; GingTrip won with a trolley.

Strength. Named HX inflight waste

Weakness. GingTrip's trolley was the theater this lacked

Takeaway. Same pain, weaker theater. Our typhoon button is the trolley. Keep it on stage.

[GitHub](#)

[asifkhan123/SMASH](#)

SyncCart

2024 · cathay-repo · participant · copy-engineering · high

Connected galley carts: Socket.IO fleet state, tablet UI, barcode, ops dashboard. Hardware-adjacent.

Strength. Crew device + galley ops, not a passenger app

Weakness. Hardware path; GingTrip still won

Takeaway. Crew-device + live fleet state is the shape. We already have it on the iPad without a cart.

[GitHub](#)

[WilliamJokuS/SyncCart](#)

All IT Dragon

2021 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Google Maps/Places for attractions and restaurants at the destination after landing.

Strength. Arrival is a real moment

Weakness. Tourist guide, not recovery

Takeaway. Landing is our moment too. The job is the missed outbound, not dinner.

[GitHub](#)

[janson0004/2021_CathayHackathon](#)

Cathay World (metaverse assistant)

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Flask + OpenAI travel assistant; airport questions redirect into a Unreal 'Cathay World'.

Strength. Shows the 2023 ceiling of participant ambition

Weakness. Metaverse + LLM, no desk, no invariant

Takeaway. If a judge asks why we did not build a world, this is why not.

[GitHub](#)

[fykhan/cathay-hackathon](#)

FlyVision AaaS

2025 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

AWS S3 + Rekognition computer vision. A year after NAAR won cargo dimensioning.

Strength. Named a real AWS cargo stack

Weakness. Copies last year's winning technique without a new desk owner

Takeaway. Do not rebuild NAAR. We already have a desk. Add theater to it, not a second CV demo.

[GitHub](#)

[Hyhen115/CathayHackathon_25](#)

Good Trip (Team 100)

2023 · cathay-repo · participant · foil · high

Flutter app from a Figma template. README is design-system boilerplate, not an airline pain.

Strength. Shows how empty the median 2023 repo is

Weakness. No BU, no number, no invariant

Takeaway. A polished UI without a desk sentence is the default. Do not demo like this.

[GitHub](#)

[EricssonXD/CathayHackathon2023](#)

Amadeus Passenger Recovery

2018 · production · production · incumbent · high

Mass reaccom: >50 flights and 8,000 pax in 40 minutes. CX live since ~2018 with Accenture chatbots and 15below.

Strength. Cathay already paid for this

Weakness. Does not walk UM/WCH through T1 in the last 90 minutes

Takeaway. Pitch beside this tool. Never instead.

No public repo

[Amadeus Passenger Recovery · Typhoon Trouble \(Airport Industry Review, 2019\)](#)

CX typhoon programme (Rogers 2019)

2019 · production · production · copy-pitch · high

Josh Rogers: 100,000 customers when the hub closes; wanted airborne reprotect on inflight Wi-Fi.

Strength. Named HKG typhoon as a yearly business challenge

Weakness. That airborne-misconnect layer is still the gap

Takeaway. Our CX254 +180 demo is the 2019 wish, on a desk iPad.

No public repo

[Typhoon Trouble](#)

United ConnectionSaver

2019 · production · production · copy-pitch · high

Holds the outbound using walk time; SMS with minutes. 3.3 million connections saved since 2019.

Strength. Walk time is a product

Weakness. Hold vs rebook is a different decision; out of our SCOPE

Takeaway. Encode walk + WCH + UM now. Hold-the-flight is LATER. Know the map.

No public repo

[United ConnectionSaver launch](#)

NASA Open MCT

2015 · aerospace · production · copy-engineering · high

Web mission-control glass: telemetry, timeline, mobile, one place.

Strength. One glass, no tab-hopping

Weakness. Spacecraft telemetry, not PNRs

Takeaway. Queue + connection + action drawer is already one glass. Say mission control, not dashboard.

[GitHub](#)

[nasa/openmct](#)

SpaceX flight software culture

2012 · aerospace · production · copy-engineering · high

Control cycle on a clock; config DSL for non-software engineers; sim + HITL; no LLM in the loop.

Strength. Determinism

Weakness. Not open source; culture analogue only

Takeaway. packages/engine is already this shape. Pitch it that way.

No public repo

[Stack Overflow: software that flies Starships](#)

amadeus-disruption-agent

2026 · irops-hack · research · copy-engineering · high

LangGraph + Amadeus APIs. LLM phrases verified facts only. RAG for EU261.

Strength. Same invariant as Reconnect: model does not decide

Weakness. Passenger-side, not HKG desk

Takeaway. Cite reasoning[] the way they cite policy passages.

[GitHub](#)

[amadeus-disruption-agent](#)

AutoRescue

2025 · irops-hack · participant · foil · high

AWS Bedrock + Amadeus search for cancelled-flight rebooking.

Strength. Live Amadeus, not only mocks

Weakness. LLM-orchestrated decisions

Takeaway. Live Amadeus is impressive.
Decision authority is not transferable to Saturday.

[GitHub](#)

[AnuR-lab/AutoRescue](#) · [Devpost: AutoRescue](#)

HKG A-CDM

2010 · production · production · copy-engineering · high

TOBT/TSAT shared clock for turnaround.
Missing passenger is an A-CDM delay reason.

Strength. Airport clock of record

Weakness. Turnaround, not PNR recovery

Takeaway. Never use the iPad wall clock. FIDS eventTime / sim clock only.

No public repo

[HKIA A-CDM Operations Guidelines](#)

Reconnect (this repo)

2026 · cathay-repo · participant · copy-engineering · high

Deterministic MCT engine + iPad triage + guarded draft. Pilot: Altéa read, FIDS MQTT, CANS push.

Strength. Zero LLM in engine

Weakness. No quantified impact yet

Takeaway. The product is already the 2026 feasibility shape. The pitch must not throw it away.

No public repo

[docs/PILOT_PROPOSAL.md](#) · [packages/engine/src/mct.ts](#)

Accenture Rebooking Experience

2018 · production · production · incumbent · high

CX self-rebook chatbots in the typhoon stack: notify, then four steps to pick a preferred flight.

Strength. Passenger self-help hours ahead

Weakness. Not a transfer-desk queue; does not escort UM/WCH through T1

Takeaway. Chatbot self-rebook is already bought. Our send is agent-approved CANS, not a second bot.

No public repo

[Typhoon Trouble \(Airport Industry Review, 2019\)](#)

15below customer communication

2018 · production · production · incumbent · high

Notification layer on CX disruption: once a new journey is accepted, 15below sends the new flight details.

Strength. CX already paid for proactive passenger comms

Weakness. Mass notify, not last-90-minute special handling

Takeaway. CANS after human confirm sits beside 15below, not over it. Do not pitch a new notification platform.

No public repo

[Typhoon Trouble \(Airport Industry Review, 2019\)](#)

Sabre IROPS Reaccommodation

2022 · production · production · incumbent · high

Mass rebook + reseat + ancillaries on Sabre PSS. Refreshed STX product: 2× faster on large disruptions.

Strength. Same job as Passenger Recovery, different PSS

Weakness. CX is Altéa, not Sabre. Pitching Sabre features at CX IT is a miss.

Takeaway. Mass IROPS is a purchased category at every major PSS. We are not in that category.

No public repo

[Sabre STX: refreshed IROPS Reaccommodation](#)

Amadeus Self Re-accommodation

2020 · production · production · incumbent · high

Passenger accepts the auto-rebook, picks an alternative, or refunds — same business rules as Passenger Recovery.

Strength. Designed so airport agents handle only the complex cases

Weakness. Self-service still does not walk UM/WCH through T1

Takeaway. CX already wants agents on the hard cases. That is the desk. Do not add a second self-rebook bot.

No public repo

[Amadeus Self Re-accommodation](#)

Plan3

2023 · production · production · incumbent · high

PSS-agnostic overlay: bundle flight + hotel + meal voucher; passenger self-serves. Sabre partnership 2023.

Strength. Duty-of-care packaging is a real airline job

Weakness. Hotel/meal chain is LATER for us

Takeaway. Holistic care is a vendor category. Do not bolt hotels onto the Saturday iPad.

No public repo

[Plan3 · Sabre-Plan3 2023](#)

HK Express Navitaire New Skies

2015 · production · production · incumbent · high

HX live on Navitaire New Skies + SkyLedger since 2015. Not Altéa. HX app also talks Amadeus + Navitaire APIs.

Strength. Named HX system of record

Weakness. Our week-1 pilot is CX Altéa office HKGCX08AA

Takeaway. GingTrip/U-Explore attached to HX. We attach to CX transfer. Do not pretend one PSS write covers both.

No public repo

[HK Express implements Navitaire \(2015\)](#)

HRS Crew & Passenger Solutions

2023 · production · production · incumbent · high

Hotels, ground transport, meals, photo-receipt reimbursement when IROPS hits. Sabre deal 2023.

Strength. The stranded-night problem is real and purchased

Weakness. Not a transfer-desk rebook

Takeaway. Count fewer stranded nights only if we measure them. Until then, omit ESG. Care vendors already exist.

No public repo

[Sabre-HRS 2023](#)

How to use this pack

Serve the folder (Chrome will not fetch JSON from `file://`):

```
python3 -m http.server 4173 --directory docs/briefing
```

Then `http://localhost:4173`. PDF: `Reconnect-competitive-intel.pdf`. CSV: `data/projects.csv`.
Markdown: `docs/competitive/`. Present: `#slides`, then `← →`.